

Sony VAIO W Series (Pink) VPCW216AG/P

Features

- Screen size: 25.7cm (10.1-inch)
- Display resolution: 1366x768 (WXGA) TFT colour display, LED backlight
- Netbook keyboard size: Approx. 16.5mm key pitch/1.2mm keystroke, 82 keys
- Operating system (Windows or Linux): Genuine Windows 7 Starter 32-bit (English Version)
- Hard drive size, type (solidstate or spinning): 320 GB (Serial ATA, 5400-rpm)
- Processor: Intel Atom N450 (1.66GHz)
- Gaming/graphics chipset: Intel Graphics Media Accelerator 3150
- Installed memory (RAM): 2GB DDR2 SDRAM (Max)
- Battery type and life: Bundled VGP-BPS18 Lithium-ion battery offering up to 1.5 hours of use; optional VGP-BPL18 Lithium-ion battery that offers up to 5 hours of use
- Wireless connectivity: Integrated Wireless LAN IEEE 802.11b/g/n, Bluetooth standard Ver. 2.1+EDR
- USB ports: High-speed USB 2.0 x 2
- Weight: 1.19 kg (including the supplied battery)



**Price
Rs 24,990**

Who should go for a netbook?

Potential users of netbooks are likely to include both first-time buyers seeking a low-cost introductory PC as well as experienced users seeking a low-cost second or third PC for themselves or a relative.

Netbooks in India are the best option for basic computer education and small business and home uses. These can perform very well for e-mailing, MS Word, MS Excel, MS PowerPoint and many others basic uses. About half the weight of a regular notebook PC and considerably smaller size are big advantages for business travelers or students who must lug a notebook on a daily basis.

Sales force automation is another area having great potential for netbooks. Companies with large sales force teams especially in the pharmaceuticals, insurance and FMCG sectors can be ideal candidates for netbooks.

Companies that are into the education sector for a large cross-section of students are also prime candidates. Loading of the courseware onto the netbooks so that students can access the courseware from the netbook is an option.

hand, provides a very standardised and user-friendly interface. The XP operating system is good for those who need an environment that they have been familiar with for the past five years or so and are looking to run legacy tools. Windows 7 Starter and Basic Editions are generally preferred because of the various enhancements over the last two Windows versions.

Wireless connectivity. Netbooks are often defined by the connectivity

they offer. The base mobility in a netbook is enabled by the WiFi chipset. Netbooks come with the 802.11a/b/g WiFi or the 802.11n standards. The a/b/g WiFi has a range of 32m indoors and 95m outdoors, which is sufficient for people looking at limited mobility. However, Dell recommends the 802.11n WiFi, which gives you double this range. This gives an opportunity for travelers to connect to networks that are not limited to the same vi-

city, but also to stretch boundaries (beaches, parks and to some extent even buses and trains). The Dell Mini 10 comes with the 802.11n WiFi by default. Wi-Fi b/g/n is six times faster than Wi-Fi b/g.

Aesthetics. Aesthetics is also important as you will be carrying the netbook in your hand. Sony netbooks are targeted at style-conscious young professionals who consider the netbook as an extension of their personality.

Upcoming trends

Netbooks are proliferating with variants of RAM, HDD and flavours of OS (Windows XP Home, Windows 7 Starter and Linux). Some of the other trends are LED-backlit panel, 3G capability, variety of colours, EnergyStar 5.0 compliance, chocolate keyboard, light weight, long battery life, Bluetooth, Web camera, card reader, multi-gesture touch pads, QuickWeb feature. With QuickWeb feature, you need not switch on the netbook and enter the password. Just press QuickWeb button, and it takes you to the Net page without booting the computer.

Do's and don'ts

While buying a netbook, check its weight, energy star compliance, battery life and screen size. HCL ME Series 06 netbook comes with 3G capability and is Energy Star 5.0 compliant. The keyboard of the netbook should not be very small like a toy for the kids. Avoid buying a small-screen netbook as it would be inconvenient to work on a small size. Finally, the netbook should have an international warranty. It's important especially for those businessmen who need to travel abroad quite frequently and may require support from the vendor.

So go ahead. Based on your budget and usage, choose the right configuration. ●

The author is a deputy editor at EFY. The prices mentioned by her are only indicative and may vary